

Day 8 — Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: map doṣa cycles to monsoon/summer/winter.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *vāta* (IAST: vāta; lit. “motion principle (wind, ākāśa+vāyu)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **The annual doṣa cycle.** Three seasonal phases dominate (varies by region):
 - **Vasanta (spring) — kapha season:** snowmelt, congestion, allergies; kapha accumulates over winter and is released now.
 - **Grīṣma + Varṣā (summer / monsoon) — pitta season:** heat, inflammation, digestive fire dips.
 - **Śarad + Hemanta + Śīśira (autumn / winter) — vāta season:** dryness, cold, wind; circulatory and joint stiffness.
2. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 6 — *ṛtucaryā* (seasonal regimen).
3. **Map to your region.** Indian classical descriptions correspond to North Indian climates. “*How do these doṣa-seasons map to YOUR local climate?*” Coastal, hill, and desert students will adapt differently.
4. **Modern bridge.** Hay-fever in spring (immune activation matching kapha-release), heat-stroke risk in summer (pitta), dry-skin and joint pain in winter (vāta) — all empirically documented in Indian medical literature.
5. **Discussion.** “*What seasonal adjustment would you make to your routine — sleep, food, exercise — based on today’s doṣa-season?*” Each student writes one specific adjustment.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Doṣa Rhythms Across Seasons.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).